

IC Paper – Northfield Offshore Wind Leasing Bid

Request: approve bid strategy and maximum option fee

Elena Márquez · 18 September 2026 · IC-2026-014

1. Decision requested

Approve participation in the Northfield offshore wind leasing round for a 1.2 GW site (PL-001), the bid strategy described below, a maximum annual option fee and a bid budget of EUR 3.1 m.

2. Site

- Water depth 35–48 m – fixed-bottom monopiles feasible with 15 MW turbines (monopile diameter 10–11 m).
- Distance to shore 52 km; grid connection to be coordinated by the system operator.
- Seabird sensitivities lower than at Harrow Bay according to Marlow Ecology's desktop review.

3. Why we can win

- Harrow Bay delivery track record: monopile campaign on schedule, 14 of 40 installed by 2 October 2026.
- Established supply chain relationships (Halden, Rhenus Steelworks, Severn Subsea Cables).
- Corporate offtake capability shown with WE-PPA-2026-004 (Arcturus Steel).

4. Bid strategy

Bid as lead developer in a 51/49 consortium with a financial partner. Option fee bid in the range agreed in the closed session; walk-away above the maximum. Wake losses from neighbouring sites estimated at 2.5–3.5 % in our yield screening.

5. Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Winner's curse on option fee	Hard cap, IRR floor 9 %
Capex inflation	15 MW turbine reference, supply chain sounding
Balance sheet capacity	Partner at 49 %, farm-down after consent
Harrow Bay team stretch (HB-RISK-017 still active)	Separate bid team led by Henrik Larsen

Decision (IC 23 September 2026): approved. Maximum option fee documented in closed minutes only.